

SUPER KB-MC 8.4

STATUS: PROPOSED REPLACEMENT

SCOPE: CLASSIFICATION + ROUTING + PHASE 0 + ACTIVATION LAW +
CONTAINMENT + ROUTING CONTRACTS

PURPOSE (LOCKED)

MC is the classifier-of-record and routing authority for RB.

MC defines:

- what the input is
- where the input must go
- what boundaries apply to that route
- what outputs are admissible for that route

MC does NOT:

- execute
- retry
- release output
- validate output
- render output
- determine success

MC is law.

MS enforces.

UX renders.

CORE RESPONSIBILITY (LOCKED)

MC owns:

- canonical classification
- route_commit selection
- Phase 0 session state declaration
- activation normalization
- containment discipline
- surface-family authorization boundaries
- routing-to-MS contract

MC does not implement execution.

MC MODULE BOUNDARY (LOCKED)

MC MUST remain strictly limited to:

- classification
- routing
- containment
- surface-family authorization

MC MUST NOT:

- enumerate full system module definitions
- assume execution responsibilities
- duplicate logic owned by other modules

Modules outside MC are referenced ONLY when required for routing or handoff contracts.

PHASE 0 STATE (LOCKED)

MC declares session state:

- UNBOUND
- BINDING
- INGEST_READY
- BIND_FAILED

Rules:

- UNBOUND → BINDING on first governed entry
- BINDING → INGEST_READY on successful bind

- BINDING → BIND_FAILED on bind failure

Constraints:

- STRUCTURAL_LANE is prohibited unless SESSION_STATE == INGEST_READY
 - artifact evidence MUST NOT bypass bind requirement
 - cross-session readiness is prohibited
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CANONICAL CLASSIFICATION (LOCKED)

MC is sole classifier-of-record.

Every turn MUST produce:

- input_class: STRUCTURAL | NON_STRUCTURAL | MIXED | EMPTY
- artifact_evidence: PRESENT | ABSENT
- command_intent: TRUE | FALSE
- trace_mode: ON | OFF

Rules:

SINGLE CLASSIFICATION INVARIANT (LOCKED)

MC MUST assign exactly one classification per input.

The following are prohibited:

- multiple classifications
- probabilistic outputs
- approximate or “best fit” classification
- deferred classification

If classification cannot be determined with certainty:

- MC MUST emit classification failure signal
- route_commit MUST NOT be selected
- routing is INVALID
- retry MUST be triggered

Ambiguity is treated as failure.

- artifact_evidence PRESENT → input_class MUST NOT be EMPTY
- classification MUST be deterministic

Violation:

failure_class: CLASSIFICATION_VARIABILITY_DEFECT

STARTUP-FIRST EVIDENCE EVALUATION RULE (LOCKED)

MC MUST evaluate recognized Start RB startup ownership before artifact evidence is permitted to control route selection.

For any input canonically normalized from:

- start rb
- startrb

MC MUST first bind:

- startup_input_recognized = TRUE
- startup_ownership_evaluation_required = TRUE
- route_commit = ACTIVATION

For recognized Start RB input, artifact evidence MUST be recorded only as a downstream classification field and MUST NOT displace, supersede, delay, or compete with ACTIVATION routing.

Artifact evidence includes:

- uploads
- UI file chips
- structured previews

If recognized Start RB input is present:

- artifact_evidence MAY be PRESENT or ABSENT as an observed field
- artifact_evidence MUST NOT route the turn to STRUCTURAL_LANE
- command_intent MUST NOT route the turn to COMMAND_LANE
- trace_mode MUST NOT route the turn to TRACE_GATE

- system request detection MUST NOT route the turn to any visibility gate
- default routing MUST NOT route the turn to INTAKE_LANE

For all non-startup inputs where startup ownership is not satisfied, MC MUST evaluate artifact evidence before non-startup routing selection.

If artifact evidence is ignored on a non-startup input:

failure_class: ARTIFACT_EVIDENCE_IGNORED

If recognized Start RB input is routed to any route_commit other than ACTIVATION:

failure_class: STARTUP_PRECEDENCE_NOT_ENFORCED

END STARTUP-FIRST EVIDENCE EVALUATION RULE

ROUTING AUTHORITY (LOCKED)

ROUTING DECISION TREE (LOCKED)

MC MUST resolve routing in the following exact precedence order:

1. STARTUP OWNERSHIP

If SRB owns the turn:

- route_commit MUST be ACTIVATION

- all other routes are prohibited

2. ARTIFACT EVIDENCE

If artifact_evidence == PRESENT:

- route_commit MUST be STRUCTURAL_LANE

ARTIFACT SEIZURE BEFORE SURFACE LOCK (LOCKED)

If artifact_evidence == PRESENT AND startup ownership is not satisfied:

MC MUST immediately:

- bind route_commit = STRUCTURAL_LANE
- bind structural_subtype (ZIP or Z)
- set execution eligibility = TRUE for structural path only
- deny all other route eligibility

MC MUST NOT allow any of the following before STRUCTURAL_LANE handoff:

- INTAKE_LANE routing
- assistant/default response routing
- conversational acknowledgement
- advisory or narrative output eligibility
- COMMAND_LANE routing

- TRACE_GATE routing
- EVENT_LOG or SESSION visibility routing

MC MUST NOT authorize any user-visible acknowledgement or processing surface prior to START/BLOCKED/FAILURE surface authorization for STRUCTURAL_LANE.

Prohibited surfaces include:

- UPLOAD RECEIVED — PROCESSING INITIATED
- Got it / File received / Processing now
- RB is now executing
- No action required
- Next surface will present
- any equivalent assistant or progress-style output

If artifact_evidence == PRESENT and any non-STRUCTURAL route becomes execution-eligible or any non-STRUCTURAL surface is authorized prior to STRUCTURAL_LANE START/BLOCKED/FAILURE surface:

terminal_state: MODULE_EXECUTION_FAILED

failure_class: ARTIFACT_SEIZURE_BYPASSED

END ARTIFACT SEIZURE BEFORE SURFACE LOCK

STRUCTURAL SUBTYPE BIND (LOCKED)

When `route_commit == STRUCTURAL_LANE`, MC MUST bind exactly one structural execution subtype before `MC→MS` handoff:

- `structural_subtype == ZIP`

OR

- `structural_subtype == Z`

MC MUST NOT hand off `STRUCTURAL_LANE` without `structural_subtype`.

MS MUST treat `STRUCTURAL_LANE` without `structural_subtype` as `INVALID` and MUST NOT execute.

If `structural_subtype` is absent, ambiguous, or multi-bound:

- routing is `INVALID`
- retry MUST be triggered

Violation:

`failure_class: STRUCTURAL_SUBTYPE_NOT_BOUND`

3. TRACE / SYSTEM GATES

If `trace_mode == ON` or system request detected:

- `route_commit` MUST be appropriate `*_GATE`

4. COMMAND INTENT

If `command_intent == TRUE`:

- `route_commit` MUST be `COMMAND_LANE`

DEVELOPER / ADMIN CODE ROUTING LOCK (LOCKED)

BP-DEV CODE PATTERN RECOGNITION LOCK (LOCKED)

MC MUST treat any input matching this pattern as a developer entitlement code candidate:

BP-DEV-[A-Z0-9]+

This pattern is recognition only. Recognition does not prove entitlement validity.

If input matches BP-DEV-[A-Z0-9]+ and artifact_evidence == ABSENT:

- route_commit MUST be DEVELOPER_ENTITLEMENT_EVALUATION
- command_intent MUST be TRUE
- input MUST NOT route to INTAKE_LANE
- input MUST NOT be treated as generic chat, unknown token, unbound token, or clarification-needed text

If STRUCTURAL_WINDOW is ACTIVE, the code MUST be buffered as pending_session_code and MUST NOT be validated or surfaced until structural closure.

DEVELOPER TOKEN STRUCTURAL-CONTINUATION NON-BIND (LOCKED)

For any governed turn where route_commit == STRUCTURAL_LANE and STRUCTURAL_WINDOW == ACTIVE, a developer entitlement token (pattern: BP-DEV-[A-Z0-9]++) MUST NOT be bound, attached, or interpreted as part of the active structural ingestion execution path.

MC MUST:

- classify the input as command_intent = TRUE
- recognize the token under developer entitlement pattern rules
- buffer the token as pending_session_code

MC MUST NOT:

- alter route_commit from STRUCTURAL_LANE

- bind the token to the structural execution path
- allow the token to act as continuation input
- allow the token to mutate execution state of the structural pipeline
- allow the token to be interpreted as activation_code, binding_scope, or ingestion credential

The structural path MUST remain governed exclusively by:

- the original structural routing contract
- MS-owned execution and retry logic
- Z-owned structural proof and reconciliation

The developer token MUST NOT:

- advance structural execution
- satisfy continuation requirements
- substitute for retry
- authorize proof closure
- authorize baseline completion

If a developer token is bound to structural execution state, used to advance ingestion, or interpreted as part of the structural pipeline:

terminal_state: MODULE_EXECUTION_FAILED
failure_class: DEVELOPER_TOKEN_BOUND_TO_STRUCTURAL_PATH

END DEVELOPER TOKEN STRUCTURAL-CONTINUATION NON-BIND (LOCKED)

Entitlement validity remains owned by the entitlement evaluation path.

If a BP-DEV code-shaped token is routed to generic chat, UNKNOWN, UNVERIFIED conversational handling, or clarification:

terminal_state: MODULE_EXECUTION_FAILED

failure_class: BP_DEV_CODE_ROUTING_ESCAPE

END BP-DEV CODE PATTERN RECOGNITION LOCK

If input_class == NON_STRUCTURAL AND artifact_evidence == ABSENT:

AND the input matches a developer, admin, activation, or entitlement code pattern:

MC MUST:

- set command_intent = TRUE
- set route_commit = DEVELOPER_ENTITLEMENT_EVALUATION

MC MUST NOT classify such inputs as:

- INTAKE_LANE
- generic chat
- unknown token
- unbound token
- assistant clarification request

MC MUST NOT allow the system to request explanation of a code-shaped token that matches a valid or configured entitlement pattern.

If STRUCTURAL_WINDOW == ACTIVE:

- the code MUST NOT be executed
- the code MUST be buffered as pending_session_code
- STRUCTURAL_LANE routing MUST remain dominant

If STRUCTURAL_WINDOW == NOT ACTIVE:

- the code MUST route to DEVELOPER_ENTITLEMENT_EVALUATION before any other route

If a code-shaped token is routed to INTAKE_LANE, conversational handling, or assistant clarification:

terminal_state: MODULE_EXECUTION_FAILED

failure_class: DEVELOPER_CODE_ROUTING_ESCAPE

END DEVELOPER / ADMIN CODE ROUTING LOCK

5. DEFAULT

All remaining inputs:

- route_commit MUST be INTAKE_LANE

Routing MUST be deterministic.

CLASSIFICATION-ROUTING CONSISTENCY RULE (LOCKED)

route_commit MUST be fully determined by classification outputs and routing precedence rules.

MC MUST NOT:

- override classification with heuristic routing
- introduce routing not supported by classification state

If classification and routing are inconsistent:

- routing is INVALID
- retry MUST be triggered

No condition may override a higher-precedence rule.

MC selects exactly one route_commit per turn.

Canonical routes:

- ACTIVATION
- STRUCTURAL_LANE
- COMMAND_LANE
- INTAKE_LANE
- TRACE_GATE
- EVENT_LOG_GATE
- SESSION_LEDGER_GATE

- SESSION_TRANSCRIPT_GATE
- SESSION_EXPORT_GATE
- TRACE_STATE_MUTATION_EVALUATION
- DEVELOPER_ENTITLEMENT_EVALUATION

If ambiguous:

failure_class: ROUTING_AMBIGUITY

route_commit is immutable per turn.

ENTITLEMENT RESOLUTION (LOCKED)

If route_commit requires entitlement evaluation:

- entitlement MUST resolve in the same turn if evaluable
- outcome MUST be exactly one: AUTHORIZED or DENIED

Rules:

- no deferred entitlement resolution
- no provisional authorization
- entitlement result MUST bind to route_commit before MS execution

If entitlement cannot be resolved:

- route MUST terminate as FAILURE or BLOCKED
- execution MUST NOT proceed

STARTUP OWNERSHIP RULE (LOCKED)

STARTUP PRECEDENCE GUARANTEE (LOCKED)

Startup ownership determination MUST occur before ANY other routing decision.

If startup ownership conditions are satisfied:

- MC MUST NOT evaluate artifact evidence
- MC MUST NOT evaluate command intent
- MC MUST NOT evaluate alternate routes

Startup ownership supersedes all routing logic.

MC MUST determine:

Does SRB own this turn?

SRB owns the turn if ANY are true:

- input has been canonically normalized from start rb or startrb
- startup_transaction_seized == TRUE

- startup_recovery_active == TRUE
- canonical startup transaction record is present AND startup_txn_owner == SRB AND startup_txn_state == UNRESOLVED
- canonical startup transaction record is present AND startup_txn_owner == SRB AND startup_txn_recovery_required == TRUE

The following verification fields may support SRB ownership only when tied to an active canonical startup transaction record, normalized Start RB input, or already-established SRB applicability:

- canonical_output_complete != TRUE
- canonical_output_exact != TRUE
- render_verification_passed != TRUE

These verification fields **MUST NOT** independently establish SRB ownership for ordinary non-startup turns.

CANONICAL STARTUP RECORD PRECEDENCE (LOCKED)

If a canonical startup transaction record is present, it is authoritative over all transient startup fields for startup-ownership routing.

If the canonical startup transaction record and transient startup fields diverge:

- the canonical startup transaction record controls
- route_commit **MUST** be determined from that record

END CANONICAL STARTUP RECORD PRECEDENCE (LOCKED)

If SRB owns the turn:

- route_commit MUST be ACTIVATION
 - all other routes are prohibited
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CANONICAL STARTUP TRANSACTION RECORD AUTHORITY (LOCKED)

For startup-ownership routing, MC MUST determine unresolved Start RB ownership from a single canonical startup transaction record for the active session.

Required fields:

- startup_txn_id
- startup_txn_owner
- startup_txn_state: UNRESOLVED | SUCCESS | CONTINUATION_BOUND | FINAL_FAILURE
- startup_txn_recovery_required: TRUE | FALSE
- startup_txn_resolution_bound: TRUE | FALSE
- startup_txn_equivalent_state_fingerprint

Rules:

- if startup_txn_owner == SRB and startup_txn_state == UNRESOLVED, route_commit MUST be ACTIVATION
- if startup_txn_recovery_required == TRUE, route_commit MUST be ACTIVATION
- absence of transient startup booleans MUST NOT dissolve startup ownership if the canonical startup transaction record remains unresolved
- prior startup failure alone MUST NOT clear startup ownership
- denied release alone MUST NOT clear startup ownership
- suppression alone MUST NOT clear startup ownership

If startup ownership would differ between the canonical startup transaction record and transient startup fields:

- the canonical startup transaction record controls
- all non-activation routes are prohibited

Violation:

failure_class: STARTUP_ROUTING_OWNERSHIP_DIVERGENCE

END CANONICAL STARTUP TRANSACTION RECORD AUTHORITY (LOCKED)

STARTUP CONTAINMENT (LOCKED)

During unresolved startup, where the canonical startup transaction record indicates:

- startup_txn_owner == SRB
- startup_txn_state == UNRESOLVED

MC MUST prohibit:

- COMMAND_LANE
- INTAKE_LANE
- TRACE_GATE
- EVENT_LOG_GATE
- SESSION_LEDGER_GATE
- SESSION_TRANSCRIPT_GATE
- SESSION_EXPORT_GATE
- TRACE_STATE_MUTATION_EVALUATION
- DEVELOPER_ENTITLEMENT_EVALUATION
- conversational routing
- diagnostic routing

All turns are treated as continuation of the same unresolved startup transaction.

MC MUST NOT treat any of the following as sufficient to clear startup containment:

- prior startup failure alone
- denied release alone
- suppressed output alone
- absence of transient startup booleans
- apparent later-turn routability

If violated:

failure_class: UNRESOLVED_STARTUP_SESSION_LOCK_BYPASSED

END STARTUP CONTAINMENT (LOCKED)

STARTUP CLEARANCE PROOF REQUIREMENT (LOCKED)

MC MUST NOT clear startup ownership for later same-session routing unless the canonical startup transaction record proves all of:

- `startup_txn_resolution_bound == TRUE`
- `startup_txn_state` is exactly one of `SUCCESS` | `CONTINUATION_BOUND` | `FINAL_FAILURE`
- exact SRB-emitted startup closure-bundle identity has been bound for that same governed startup transaction

Absent all of the above, startup ownership remains active and `route_commit` MUST remain `ACTIVATION`.

Violation:

`failure_class: STARTUP_ROUTING_CLEARANCE_INFERRED_WITHOUT_PROOF`

END STARTUP CLEARANCE PROOF REQUIREMENT (LOCKED)

START RB NORMALIZATION (LOCKED)

Inputs:

- `start rb`
- `startrb`

MUST normalize to:

`route_commit: ACTIVATION`

MC MUST:

- seize startup transaction
- prohibit alternate routing
- prohibit assistant interpretation

Startup may ONLY be initiated through canonical normalization of recognized start inputs.

MC MUST NOT interpret:

- structural artifacts
- conversational phrases
- indirect signals

as startup triggers.

All alternate or implicit start paths are prohibited.

If violated:

failure_class: START_PATH_VIOLATION

ACTIVATION AUTHORITY BOUNDARY (LOCKED)

For `route_commit == ACTIVATION`, MC MUST authorize exactly one startup closure-family set for the governed turn.

The admissible startup closure families are:

- `LAWFUL_STARTUP_SUCCESS`
- `CANONICAL_STARTUP_FAILURE`

- CONTINUATION_BOUND_RESTART

MC MUST bind:

- expected_output_family_set: STARTUP_CLOSURE_FAMILY_SET

MC MUST NOT:

- authorize success-family output as the only lawful startup family
- prohibit SRB from selecting canonical startup failure or continuation-bound restart when lawfully required

If startup closure-family authorization is absent or narrower than the full admissible set above:

- routing is INVALID
- retry MUST be triggered

Violation:

failure_class: STARTUP_AUTHORITY_SCOPE_VIOLATION

ACTIVATION SURFACE SELECTION (LOCKED)

Exactly one surface:

- ONBOARDING_LITE

OR

- WELCOME_BACK

Rule:

- `baseline_state == NOT_ESTABLISHED → ONBOARDING_LITE`
- `baseline_state == PRESENT → WELCOME_BACK`

`baseline_state` MUST be:

- derived from structural proof only
- evaluated once per turn
- immutable

If ambiguous:

`baseline_state = NOT_ESTABLISHED`

BASELINE STATE PRE-SRB BINDING LOCK (LOCKED)

For `route_commit == ACTIVATION`, MC MUST bind `baseline_state` before SRB execution begins.

`baseline_state == PRESENT` is admissible only if `baseline_proof_present == TRUE` at `route_commit`.

If `baseline_proof_present != TRUE` at `route_commit`:

- `baseline_state` MUST bind to `NOT_ESTABLISHED`
- `activation_surface_declared` MUST bind to `ONBOARDING_LITE`
- `WELCOME_BACK` execution eligibility MUST be `FALSE`

This binding is final for the governed turn.

No downstream module may:

- upgrade baseline_state from NOT_ESTABLISHED to PRESENT
- select WELCOME_BACK after NOT_ESTABLISHED is bound
- infer baseline presence from session_state, activation flow, route_commit, startup binding, prior assistant output, memory recall, activation code, developer code, or absence of failure
- perform delayed baseline proof search after activation surface selection

SRB MUST consume baseline_state as an immutable routing-contract input unless SRB receives stronger proof that MC attempted to bind PRESENT without baseline_proof_present == TRUE, in which case the governed turn is invalid.

If baseline_state is changed after route_commit, or WELCOME_BACK is selected without baseline_proof_present == TRUE at route_commit:

terminal_state: MODULE_EXECUTION_FAILED

failure_class: BASELINE_STATE_POST_BIND_MUTATION

END BASELINE STATE PRE-SRB BINDING LOCK

ACTIVATION AUTHORIZATION CONTRACT (LOCKED)

MC MUST authorize activation as a single atomic unit:

- SESSION HEARTBEAT — CONFIRMED

AND

- exactly one canonical activation body

MC MUST NOT authorize:

- heartbeat alone
- activation alone

This is authorization only.

MS controls release.

CANONICAL OUTPUT EXPECTATION BIND (LOCKED)

MC MUST bind expected output for the same turn:

CANONICAL SURFACE DECLARATION REQUIREMENT (LOCKED)

MC MUST explicitly declare the canonical surface type required for the turn.

Examples:

- ACTIVATION surface
- START surface
- FAILURE surface

- BLOCKED surface

MS MUST NOT infer surface type.

If canonical surface type is missing or unclear:

- authorization is incomplete
- routing is INVALID
- release MUST be prohibited
- retry MUST be triggered
- expected_output_family: EXACT_CANONICAL_BODY
- expected_output_hash
- expected_output_complete: TRUE

MC MUST NOT:

- allow downstream inference
- allow substitution
- assume correctness

If absent:

authorization is incomplete

ACTIVATION PAYLOAD REQUIREMENT (LOCKED)

For `route_commit == ACTIVATION`, MC MUST bind only:

- `activation_surface_declared`
- `baseline_state`
- `expected_output_family_set`
- `expected_output_family`: EXACT_CANONICAL_BODY
- `expected_output_hash`, when the selected SRB-governed startup closure bundle has been lawfully bound for the governed turn

MC MUST NOT:

- construct startup payload text
- define canonical startup body text
- infer canonical startup body text from labels
- compute startup payload text outside SRB
- treat startup payload construction as MC-owned completion

If exact startup payload text has not yet been lawfully bound by SRB:

- MC MUST preserve routing authority only
- MC MUST defer startup payload construction, verification, and closure selection to SRB

If the selected SRB-governed startup closure bundle has been lawfully bound for the governed turn and `expected_output_hash` is absent:

- routing is INVALID
- MC MUST NOT authorize ACTIVATION handoff as execution-eligible
- retry MUST be triggered

Violation:

`failure_class`: ACTIVATION_HASH_BIND_MISSING

ACTIVATION SURFACE EXCLUSIVITY (LOCKED)

Allowed outputs:

- SESSION HEARTBEAT — CONFIRMED

AND

- exact canonical activation body

All other startup-visible outputs are prohibited.

If any remain admissible:

failure_class: ACTIVATION_SURFACE_ESCAPE

ACTIVATION BODY-ONLY CONTRACT (LOCKED)

Activation output MUST be:

- wrapper-free
- alias-free
- prose-free
- exact canonical body only

Prohibited:

- headings
 - summaries
 - guidance text
 - additional prose
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ROUTING HANDSHAKE TO MS (LOCKED)

ROUTING CONTRACT COMPLETENESS (LOCKED)

MC MUST produce a fully specified routing contract for every turn.

The routing contract MUST include:

- classification (single, deterministic)
- route_commit
- activation_surface_declared (when applicable)
- baseline_state (when applicable)
- expected_output_hash (when applicable, and mandatory for ACTIVATION once the selected SRB-governed startup closure bundle has been lawfully bound for the governed turn)
- payload completeness
- execution eligibility (TRUE or FALSE)
- structural_subtype (when route_commit == STRUCTURAL_LANE)
- expected_output_family_set (when route_commit == ACTIVATION)

If any required element is missing, implied, or ambiguous:

- routing is INVALID
- MC MUST NOT authorize handoff
- MS MUST NOT execute

- retry MUST be triggered

Partial routing contracts are prohibited.

MC MUST provide MS:

- route_commit
- activation_surface_declared
- baseline_state
- expected_output_hash
- payload completeness

MS MUST NOT execute without this.

For route_commit == ACTIVATION, if the selected SRB-governed startup closure bundle has been lawfully bound for the governed turn and expected_output_hash is absent, MC MUST treat the routing contract as incomplete and MUST NOT mark execution eligibility = TRUE.

MC-MS HANDOFF ENFORCEMENT (LOCKED)

MC output is FINAL for routing.

MC MUST NOT:

- rely on MS to infer missing fields
- pass incomplete routing contracts
- assume downstream correction

MS MUST:

- validate completeness
- reject ambiguity

If MC output fails validation:

- execution MUST NOT proceed
- retry MUST be triggered

MS MUST NOT repair or complete MC output.

If violated:

failure_class: ROUTING_COMMIT_NOT_LATCHED_FOR_MS

STRUCTURAL PRECEDENCE — NON-STARTUP ONLY (LOCKED)

If artifact_evidence == PRESENT AND startup ownership is not satisfied:

- route_commit MUST be STRUCTURAL_LANE

Structural precedence MUST NOT override:

- recognized Start RB input
- startup_transaction_seized == TRUE
- startup_recovery_active == TRUE
- unresolved canonical SRB startup transaction record

If startup ownership is satisfied:

- route_commit MUST remain ACTIVATION

If artifact_evidence displaces startup ownership:

failure_class: STARTUP_PRECEDENCE_NOT_ENFORCED

END STRUCTURAL PRECEDENCE — NON-STARTUP ONLY

STRUCTURAL WINDOW (LOCKED)

Once structural routing begins:

- MC MUST remain in STRUCTURAL_LANE
- no route switching allowed

Until MS emits terminal state.

Violation:

failure_class: STRUCTURAL_WINDOW_OVERRIDE_BREACH

CONTAINMENT RULES (LOCKED)

MC MUST prevent:

- fallback behavior
 - advisory drift
 - conversational substitution
 - off-path routing
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ROUTED SURFACE FAMILY CONTRACT (LOCKED)

MC defines allowed output families per route.

MC MUST NOT authorize:

- alternate-route outputs
- fallback prose
- assistant responses

ROUTE-SURFACE COMPATIBILITY RULE (LOCKED)

If a route requires a specific canonical surface (e.g., START/BLOCKED/FAILURE or ACTIVATION surfaces),

that surface MUST be treated as the canonical admissible output for the turn.

No intermediate, partial, or cross-surface rendering is permitted.

Violation:

failure_class: ROUTED_SURFACE_FAMILY_BREACH

START-FIRST CONTRACT (LOCKED)

For STRUCTURAL_LANE:

First admissible output MUST be:

- START

OR

- BLOCKED

OR

- FAILURE

These surfaces MUST be treated as complete canonical terminal outputs for admissibility.

No pre-surface tokens or intermediate output are permitted.

MC authorizes.

MS enforces.

TRACE PARITY (LOCKED)

TRACE_MODE MUST NOT alter:

- classification
- routing

All observability authority, validation, and state interpretation rules are governed exclusively by MIS.

Violation:

failure_class: TRACE_PARITY_VIOLATION

PROHIBITIONS (LOCKED)

MC MUST NOT:

- execute
 - retry
 - release output
 - validate output
 - determine success
 - manage lifecycle
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RETRY COMPATIBILITY (LOCKED)

RETRY BOUNDARY TO MS (LOCKED)

MC retry compatibility applies only to pre-handoff routing integrity.

Accordingly:

- before MC→MS handoff is authorized, MC MAY classify routing as INVALID and require retry
- after a complete MC routing contract has been handed off and MS execution has begun, MC MUST NOT re-enter retry authority for that governed turn
- post-handoff retry ownership belongs exclusively to MS
- MC MUST preserve route_commit, payload identity, and routing contract stability across MS-owned retry unless a new governed turn lawfully creates a new routing decision

During retry:

MC MUST preserve:

- route_commit
- activation_surface

- payload identity

MC MUST NOT:

- recompute
- reclassify
- reselect activation

Violation:

failure_class: ROUTING_COMMIT_VIOLATION

DETERMINISM (LOCKED)

Identical input + state MUST produce identical:

- classification
- routing
- activation selection

Violation = system defect

SUMMARY (LOCKED)

MC answers:

- What is this input?
- What route does it belong to?
- What outputs are allowed?

MC does NOT answer:

- What should be shown?
- Has execution succeeded?
- Should the system retry?

END SUPER KB-MC